

SI XU

Tel: (+44) 07469187560 | ✉ si.xu.20@ucl.ac.uk |  
30 Gordon Street, London, WC1H 0QB, United Kingdom

EDUCATION

University College London, London, UK

PhD Candidate

MRes in Economics

Sep 2021 - present

Sep 2020 - Sep 2021

Duke University, Durham, NC, US

Master of Arts in Economics

Aug 2018 - May 2020

Central University of Finance and Economics, Beijing, China

Bachelor in Economics

Sep 2014 - June 2018

RESEARCH INTERESTS

Primary: Labor Economics, Economics of Ageing

Secondary: Public Policy

JOB MARKET PAPER

Employment Persistence after Raising Pensionable Age: Evidence from Japan

(with Saisawat Samutpradit)

Abstract: This paper examines how raising the pension eligibility age affects retirement behavior in Japan. Using administrative tax data, we analyze a reform that increased the eligibility age for pension benefits from 60 to 61 for certain cohorts. Leveraging a difference-in-differences approach, we find that affected cohorts increased their employment rate at age 60 by approximately 5 percentage points relative to unaffected cohorts. Moreover, the employment effects persisted beyond the new eligibility threshold: affected cohorts remained more likely to work between ages 62 and 64, even after becoming eligible for pension benefits. As a result, the reform induced roughly 60 percent of individuals who otherwise would have exited labor force to work approximately three additional years on average. This persistent effect is unlikely to be driven by income or wealth effects. Instead, it reflects two key features of Japan's labor market institutions at older ages: (1) workers are mandated to resign new contracts at age 60 to continue employment, often involving substantial changes in work arrangements; and (2) strong employment protection rules apply until age 65. The results suggest that policies aimed at extending the working lives of older individuals should not only address demand-side constraints but also facilitate transitions to new job arrangements later in life.

OTHER WORK IN PROGRESS

Old-age Pension Earnings Test and Labor Supply of Elderly Men: Evidence from Residential Tax Records in Japan *(with Ayako Kondo & Saisawat Samutpradit)*

Labor Market Outcomes of Older Workers Across the Business Cycle *(with Hyejin Ku)*

OTHER AFFILIATIONS

Centre for Research and Analysis of Migration (CReAM)

Research Officer

Sep 2021 - Present

Center for Research and Education in Program Evaluation, University of Tokyo

Visiting researcher

March 2024 - Present

Rockwool Foundation Berlin

Research Affiliate

June 2025 - Present

TEACHING

University College London, Department of Economics

Postgraduate Teaching Assistant mentors

Sep 2025 - Present

ECON0056 Economics of Education

Jan 2023 - Present

ECON0002/0095 Economics

Oct 2021 - May 2022

ECON0009 Introduction to Economic Thinking

Jan 2023 - March 2024

Duke University, Department of Economics

Selected Topics in Economics: Microeconomic tools

Jan 2020 - May 2020

Duke University, Fuqua Business School

Quantitative Business Analysis

July 2019 - Aug 2019

Central University of Finance and Economics, Department of Economics

Intermediate Macroeconomics

2015

PRE-PHD RESEARCH

Duke University, US

Research Assistant to Professor Marjorie B. McElroy

June 2019 - April 2020

Research Assistant to Assistant Professor Ines Black

June 2019 - Sep 2019

Independent Study with Prof. Arnaud Maurel

Aug 2019 - Nov 2019

Central University of Finance and Economics, Beijing, China

Research Assistant to Associate Professor Chuanchuan Zhang

Sep 2016 - June 2018

Research Assistant to Professor Binkai Chen

Sep 2015 - Sep 2016

CONFERENCE/WORKSHOP/PRESENTATIONS

- | | |
|-------------|--|
| 2025 | CReAM Spring workshop & Brown Bag seminar University College London
ENTER seminar Tilburg University
Workshop on the Economics of Aging Rockwool Foundation Berlin
OLS seminar University of Osaka
ENTER Jamboree Conference Stockholm School of Economics
CEPR Economics Job Market Bootcamp
Retirement Sector Seminar Institute for Fiscal Studies
CEPR Summer Conference: The Economics of Longevity & Ageing*
RFBerlin-CReAM Summer Workshop |
| 2024 | Applied Micro PhD Research Day University College London
CReAM Brown Bag Seminar University College London |
| 2023 | Asian and Australasian Society of Labor Economics (AASLE) Conference, Taipei |
| 2022 | CReAM 20th Anniversary Workshop on Topics in Labour Economics |

* Invited to attend without presenting

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

CReAM – Co-organizer for Brown Bag seminars | London | 2024 - Present

Accenture (China) Co., Ltd. – Business Analysis Intern | Beijing | April - July 2018

Prudential Hong Kong – Financial management Intern | Hong Kong | Jan - Feb 2016

Tsinghua University Schwarzman College – Fundraising Intern | Beijing | July 2017 - Feb 2018

FELLOWSHIPS AND AWARDS

2020-Present	University College London PhD Studentship
2019-2020	M.A. Merit Scholar Award
2017	Meritorious Prize for Mathematical Contest in Modeling (top 10-15%)
2014-2018	National Soong Ching Ling Development Foundation “Jingshu Ping Scholarship” (top 1%) Dean’s list for “Outstanding Achievement Award” (top 4%) Scholarship for Academic Excellence and Comprehensive Development (top 4%)

OTHER SKILLS

Analysis	Stata, Matlab, R, MSQl, Latex, HTML
Certificate	Association of Chartered Certified Accountants (Intermediate level, F1-F9)
Sports	Rock climbing (V5), Half-marathon

REFERENCES

Professor Hyejin Ku

University College London
h.ku@ucl.ac.uk

Professor Christian Dustmann

University College London
c.dustmann@ucl.ac.uk

Professor Attila Lindner

University College London
a.lindner@ucl.ac.uk

Professor Uta Schönberg

The University of Hong Kong
schoenbe@hku.hk